

DECORY EDWARDS

Teaching Statement

Draft for review | September 2026

Teaching Philosophy

I approach teaching as the process of helping students move from confusion to an understanding they can explain, test, and use independently. Because students differ in preparation, confidence, and the examples that make an idea intuitive, effective instruction requires more than presenting correct material. It requires diagnosing the obstacle, changing the representation, and providing structured practice. I aim to create a classroom in which questions are treated as evidence about students' reasoning, not as signs that they do not belong.

My instruction begins with intuition and moves deliberately toward formal analysis. I often start with a concrete decision faced by a household, firm, or policymaker; identify the relevant incentives and constraints; translate them into a graph or model; and then return to evidence. This sequence helps students understand why a method works instead of memorizing when to use it. Worked examples, low-stakes practice, and transparent expectations give students a clear path toward the analytical standard of the course.

Teaching Experience

At Johns Hopkins, I served as a teaching assistant for three semesters of Elements of Macroeconomics and three semesters of Macroeconomic Theory, leading weekly discussion sections and holding office hours for courses of approximately 25 to 40 students. I also supported Debates in Macroeconomics, a sixteen-student upper-level seminar that used economic models to evaluate policy questions involving climate change, immigration, and inequality. These roles taught me to anticipate common conceptual errors, connect lectures to assignments, and explain the same model in several ways.

Private tutoring has broadened the range of students and subjects I teach. I have worked with learners from middle-school mathematics through undergraduate economics, statistics, econometrics, and data analysis, including recent work in linear algebra, calculus, and MBA economics. Tutoring has reinforced the value of adapting explanations to the student while maintaining high expectations. I review materials in advance, make each session's goals explicit, and leave students with a clear account of what they have mastered and what should come next.

Scope of Teaching

Macroeconomics is the area in which I have the deepest classroom experience. In principles and intermediate courses, I connect core models of growth, business cycles, inflation, unemployment, money, and fiscal and monetary policy to current data. My research on household finance and inequality also provides a natural way to show why heterogeneity matters for consumption, saving, policy transmission, and welfare. Students should be able both to solve a model and to judge whether its abstractions fit the policy question at hand.

In applied microeconomics, I would organize instruction around incentives, institutions, market failures, and empirical policy evaluation. Examples from education, energy, and health make these tools concrete while introducing causal reasoning, careful data construction, and methods such as difference-in-differences and event studies. Where useful, I would incorporate reproducible analysis in Stata or Python. I could also develop an upper-level course in Applied Policy Analysis using cases from these fields, while adapting its content and structure to departmental priorities and existing curricula.

Courses I Am Prepared to Teach

I am prepared to teach Principles of Macroeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory, Principles of Microeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Money and Banking, Household Finance, Economic Inequality, Public Policy, introductory Econometrics, and applied data analysis in Stata or Python. I would follow established syllabi and departmental needs while bringing clear explanations, careful preparation, and relevant applications to each course. Across subjects, my goal is consistent: students should gain economic intuition, formal discipline, empirical judgment, and the confidence to use those tools beyond the classroom.